✦ TALES OF JUPITER WISDOM • BOOK III ✦

TOPS AND ROOTS

The Peasant & The Bear • Wisdom of the Tale for Little & Grown-Up Readers



ZINAIDA JUPITER
Doctor of Business Administration (DBA)

ILLUSTRATED FAMILY & EXECUTIVE FABLE COLLECTION

ZINAIDA JUPITER

TOPS AND ROOTS

The Classic Russian Fable of the Peasant and the Bear with a Lesson in Resourcefulness for Children (6+) and an Executive Value-Creation Matrix for Leaders (DBA)

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SERIES: “TALES OF JUPITER WISDOM”

“A Warm Tale for the Child • A Wise Strategy for the Leader”

Book III
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6+

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Tops and Roots (The Peasant and the Bear) : A Russian Folk Fable with a Wisdom Lesson for Children and an Executive Deal-Design Matrix for Adults / retold with commentary by Zinaida Jupiter (DBA). — 2026. — 12 p. : col. ill. — (Tales of Jupiter Wisdom ; vol. 3). — Reading age: 6+.

Illustrated in the museum canon of Ivan Bilibin (`STYLE_1`), this witty Russian fable of turnips and golden wheat combines bedtime storytelling (6+) with a Doctor of Business Administration (DBA) 2×2 matrix on domain mastery, information asymmetry, and partnership equity design.

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❖ A Note to the Reader ❖

Dear Reader! In just five pages, the classic Russian fable "Tops and Roots" illustrates a truth taught in the world's top executive boardrooms. When a child listens to the story, they laugh at how the Peasant's knowledge of nature outsmarts the grumpy Bear's brute force. When a business leader or investor reads the same tale, they immediately recognize why powerful players who dictate deal terms ("I take the tops!" / "Now I take the roots!") without understanding the underlying product end up empty-handed twice in a row.

Following the story, you will find two tailored sections: **a children's lesson in curiosity and smart work (pp. 8–9)** and **an executive 2×2 "Tops & Roots" Deal-Design Matrix for leaders (pp. 10–11)**.

With warmth to your family — Zinaida Jupiter,
Doctor of Business Administration (DBA)

TOPS AND ROOTS

A Classic Russian Folk Fable Retold for Family Reading

— ❖ ❧ ❖ —



“Whoever knows the craft down to its roots keeps the harvest even beside a mighty neighbor.”

One bright spring morning, a hardworking Russian Peasant wore his embroidered linen shirt (*kosovorotka*) out to a sunny forest clearing to plow the soil and sow sweet golden turnips. No sooner had he cut the first furrow than out stepped a huge brown Bear from the ancient oak woods, growling fiercely: *“Peasant! How dare you plow in my forest? I’ll crush you where you stand!”*

The clever Peasant tipped his cap calmly and replied: *“Hold your temper, Master Bear! Let us be partners instead: I will plow the earth, sow the seed, and tend the crop, and in autumn we shall*



“The eye sees the tall green leaves above, while wisdom knows where the golden fruit ripens.”

All summer long the Peasant tended the clearing, weeding every row and watering the soil with clear spring water. By autumn the turnips had grown round, firm, and glowing like amber beneath the earth! As the Peasant brought his wooden cart to dig the crop, out marched the Bear from the thicket: *“Well, Peasant, keep your word—hand over my tops!”*

With a cheerful bow, the Peasant sliced off every green turnip leaf and piled them into a mountain twice as tall as the Bear: *“Here is every single top, Master Bear, exactly as we agreed!”* Delighted by the sheer size of his green pile, the Bear gathered the leaves in his huge paws and lumbered back to his den, while the Peasant loaded the sweet golden turnips onto his cart.



“Whoever chooses a share by outward size alone chews bitter leaves instead of sweet roots.”

Sitting down on a mossy stump, the Bear took a big bite of his green turnip tops—and grimaced! They were tough, stringy, and bitter as bark. Just then, the Peasant rode past along the forest road, happily munching a slice of steamed golden turnip: *“Hey, Peasant! What are you eating on that cart?” — “Only my humble roots, Master Bear!”*

The Peasant tossed him a single golden turnip. The Bear crunched it —and found it sweeter than honey! Roaring with wounded pride, the Bear shook his paw: *“You tricked me, Peasant! Your roots are sweet while my tops are bitter! Mark my words: next year when you sow in this clearing, the roots are mine and the tops are yours!”*



“Yesterday’s formula works in reverse tomorrow if you fail to notice that the crop has changed.”

When the next spring arrived, the wise Peasant returned to the same sunny clearing—but this time, instead of turnips, he sowed **tall golden wheat**. By late summer the field rippled like a sea of gold, heavy with fragrant grain ears.

Out strode the Bear at harvest time, pointing his heavy paw straight at the ground: *“Remember our new contract, Peasant! Last autumn I lost out on the tops—you won’t fool me twice! Hand over the roots to me, and keep the tops for yourself!”* The Peasant nodded respectfully: *“As you command, Master Bear—a deal is a deal!”*



“True wealth always belongs to the one who unites honest labor with deep knowledge.”

Together they reaped the field: the Peasant stacked the rich golden wheat ears—the **tops**—high upon his wagon, leaving the Bear a massive heap of dry, dusty wheat roots. The Peasant milled fine white flour and baked warm braided loaves (*kalachi*) for his family, while the Bear chewed on the scratchy wheat stubble until his jaws ached!

Seeing that he had outsmarted himself a second time, the furious Beargrowled, stomped off into the deep woods, and never meddled in the Peasant’s farming again. And the Peasant and his family enjoyed warm golden bread all winter long.

A LESSON IN SMART KNOWLEDGE FOR CHILDREN (6+)

Why Is a Curious Mind Stronger Than a Bear's Paw?

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The Secret of the Tale: The Bear wanted the biggest share without working or learning how plants grow. The Peasant worked hard with his own hands and knew the secret of every seed!

Question I. Why did the Bear choose the "tops" of the turnips in the first year without checking what grew underground?
Question II. Why did the Bear make a second mistake when he demanded the "roots" of the golden wheat?
Question III. How could the Bear and the Peasant have become true friends if the Bear had helped plow and guard the field?

❖ The Wise Craftsman's Proverb ❖

"Force without knowledge grabs empty leaves; knowledge with honest work gathers the golden harvest!"

YOUNG EXPLORER PRACTICE (6+)

Decision Game: "Where Does Nature Hide Its Treasure?"

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Imagine you and a friend planted crunchy carrots and sweet strawberries in a garden. Which path does a wise gardener choose at harvest time?

Path A (The Bear's Greed): Grab the biggest pile of green leaves without knowing what plant it is.

Path B (The Stubborn Habit): Dig up only the roots of every plant—even the strawberry bushes!

Path C (The Master's Wisdom — Winning Choice!): Learn how each plant grows—harvest the sweet roots of carrots and the ripe berries on top of strawberries, and share fairly with the friend who helped!

Draw a golden turnip growing underground ("roots") and a tall ear of wheat shining in the sun ("tops"):

Space for Your Drawing

- **Rule 1:** Always understand how something works down to its roots before making a choice.
- **Rule 2:** Respect everyone's effort: those who work together share the best harvest together.

STRATEGIC DECISION MATRIX • DOCTOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (DBA)

The "Tops & Roots Matrix": 4 Deal-Design Models

The Core Paradox: why does the dominant resource holder (the Bear) dictate the contract terms twice in a row, yet walk away with zero value both times? Let us map the four positions across **two executive axes (Y-Axis and X-Axis)**:

❖ THE 2×2 MATRIX: PRODUCT MASTERY VS. PARTNERSHIP DESIGN ❖

LOW • Y-AXIS: PRODUCT & VALUE MASTERY • HIGH →

High Mastery + Defensive Split (Top-Left)

2. "The Peasant's Asymmetry"

Deep domain knowledge protects the operator from a bully's extortion, saving the harvest—yet leaves the partnership broken for the future.

★ WINNING ANSWER (TOP-RIGHT CORNER)

4. "Mastery & Capital Alliance"

High product mastery + aligned equity design. Capital (the land) and expertise (the farmer) share the net finished harvest rather than splitting "tops vs. roots."

Zero Mastery + Coercion (Bottom-Left)

1. "The Bear's Turnip Dictate"

Using brute leverage ("Give me the tops!") without understanding unit economics. You capture bulky vanity metrics while missing all real profit.

Rigid Template + Blindness (Bottom-Right)

3. "The Bear's Wheat Reflex"

Mechanically copying yesterday's lesson ("Now I only take roots!") into a new industry where the value engine has moved to the top.

◄ Low (Force & Greed)X-AXIS: PARTNERSHIP EQUITY DESIGNHigh (Aligned

❧ How to Read All 4 Quadrants of the Matrix (Simple & Clear):

Quadrant 1 ("The Bear's Turnip Dictate"): The dominant investor's trap—demanding flashy surface volume ("the green leaves") without knowing where margin lives.

Quadrant 2 ("The Peasant's Asymmetry"): Using superior product knowledge as a shield against coercion—effective once or twice, but ends in permanent rivalry.

Quadrant 3 ("The Bear's Wheat Reflex"): Fighting the last war—applying an old contract template to a new business model.

★ **Quadrant 4 ("Mastery & Capital Alliance" — Top-Right Corner):** The winning executive model—aligning resource owners and domain experts around shared net value.

DEAL-STRUCTURING PLAYBOOK

How to Move into the Top-Right Quadrant (Quadrant 4)

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Step 1. Audit the Value Chain Before Splitting Shares (Anti-Bear): Before negotiating revenue vs. equity, identify whether the venture is a "turnip business" (deep IP/asset value) or a "wheat business" (cash-flow yield).

Step 2. Never Copy-Paste Old Term Sheets: A clause that protected you in real estate ("roots") will leave you holding dry straw in AI or education ("tops").

Step 3. Share the Baked Bread, Not the Raw Plant (Quadrant 4 Rule): Align both capital and operator around the final net profit pool so neither side can game the split:

Deal & Partnership Scenario	Quadrant 1/3: The Bear's Mistake	★ Quadrant 4: "Mastery & Capital Alliance"
An investor enters an AI or educational company	Demand 70% of gross top-line ("tops"), starving the operating team.	Share net profit and long-term equity proportionally between capital and domain expertise.
Entering a new market after a past loss	Blindly invert the previous contract ("Only roots this time!").	Map where the true economic value is generated in the new product before drafting terms.
Global Wisdom Echo (BRICS Bridge)	Relying on brute leverage over competence.	Russian fable wisdom meets Chinese *Wù Běn (务本 — master the root)* & Indian *Panchatantra*.

Write down one deal or project where you must verify where the true "roots" and "tops" of value lie:

❖ The Leader's Maxim ❖

"Capital without competence harvests bitter leaves; competence aligned with capital builds a golden granary."

SUMMARY OF BOOK III: “TOPS AND ROOTS”

Two Golden Keys of the Fable

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❖ Key for the Child (6+)

1. Learn How Things Grow: curiosity and knowledge always outsmart greedy force.

2. Work with Care: a rich harvest comes to patient hands, not loud growls.

3. Share Fairly: true partners help each other plow, sow, and celebrate together.

★ Key for the Leader (DBA)

1. Operate in the Top-Right Quadrant (Quadrant 4): product mastery + aligned equity design.

2. Know the Value Engine: never confuse bulky vanity metrics (“leaves”) with core profit (“roots”).

3. Drop Rigid Templates: every new market requires fresh unit-economics analysis.

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A Classic Russian Folk Fable with a Wisdom Lesson for Children and an Executive Deal-Design Matrix for Adults

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